Quantic Capstone

Mar 18, 2026 · 8:00 PM - 9:00 PM · Bloomquist, Taylor

View recap

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Decisions

- Monetization for phase one will be data/ad sales; subscriptions in later phases.
- Overseas freelancers will be used for development to reduce costs.
- Sploot will be the company name; sploot.love domain secured.
- Michelle will draft and share the marketing plan by Sunday night.
- Nick and Tom will collaborate on the operations plan and share drafts.
- Gurpreet will upload the financial draft plan for review.
- Taylor will develop the website; logo/theme to be decided via Slack.
- App will feature swipe-right, dating-style interface for dog matching.
- Next meeting scheduled for first week of April, skipping next week.

Open questions

- Government funding eligibility for for-profit or nonprofit needs more research.
- Quantic requirements for proof of concept vs. business plan need clarification.
- Pricing and marketing strategy for user acquisition and break-even needs finalization.
- References and background research placement in business plan needs decision.
- Tagline and branding for Sploot need to be finalized.

Agenda

Meeting notes

Personal achievements

- Taylor shared that their author website received 6,500 visitors and sold 75 books in two weeks.

Meeting logistics

- Participants discussed challenges with joining the meeting due to Teams account and settings issues.

Business model review

- Tom, Gurpreet, Taylor, and Nick reviewed the company's business model, confirming initial revenue will come from selling acquired data, with future plans for subscription services.

Development cost estimates

- Gurpreet explained that development costs are significantly lower with Eastern European freelancers compared to North American rates, estimating 80-150 hours for iOS and Android build.

Branding decisions

- Participants agreed that the company name "Splood" is memorable and suitable for branding and social media trends.

Branding and web presence

- Tom shared that they registered the domain sploot.love and experimented with Wix and Squarespace to create a proof-of-concept website for the project.
- Taylor explained their process for setting up their author website, including using Cheap Name, Cloudflare, GitHub, and AI tools, with minimal expenses.

Project requirements

- Participants discussed the need to clarify Quantic's expectations regarding whether a proof of concept or only a business plan is required for their project evaluation.
- Tom confirmed that the business plan and pitch presentation are required as separate graded submissions for the project, with the business plan needing to be 30-35 pages and future oriented.

Research and case studies

- Taylor explained that Goodpup's partnership with shelters significantly reduced return rates, serving as a relevant case study for the group's platform concept.
- Taylor described research showing that a bad adoption experience leads to people never adopting again, supporting the platform's focus on improving match quality.

Funding opportunities

- The group discussed the possibility of qualifying for government or shelter funding, but Gurpreet noted that as a for-profit entity, they may not be eligible for the same funding as non-profits.
- Nick suggested identifying potential grants or funding sources and including one or two as assumptions in the project's financial projections.

- Tom shared that Carl Icahn donated $200 million to iPaw for kill shelters, highlighting potential philanthropic funding sources for the project.
- Gurpreet explained that partner shelters could apply for government grants to improve adoption efficiency and share a portion of the funding with the company.

Project progress

- Nick and Tom compared their draft business plan to provided examples and agreed their version is strong and on the right track.

Business model and structure

- Participants discussed the challenges and optics of structuring the business as a nonprofit versus a for-profit, including concerns about administration costs and public perception.

Development and operational costs

- Gurpreet explained that initial development costs for the MVP are estimated at $50,000, with ongoing app maintenance projected at $1,500 per month.

Marketing and user acquisition

- Taylor and Gurpreet highlighted that marketing and user acquisition costs in the pet app space are significantly high, with estimates ranging from $45 to $85 per install or action, and much of the expense driven by bot clicks.
- Michelle explained that influencer marketing and referral incentives could reduce cost per install (CPI) by up to 40%, making it feasible to target a CPI under $20 with the right partnerships.
- Gurpreet noted that app installs filter out bots more effectively than website clicks, resulting in more accurate user acquisition costs.

Business plan deliverables

- Nick identified that the marketing plan and positioning strategy are still outstanding components of the business plan and need to be completed.

Financial projections and pricing

- Bloomquist, Taylor explained that to reach 100,000 paying users by year one, the team would need to invest approximately $500,000 in marketing, requiring a monthly subscription price of $5-6 to break even.
- Participants discussed that to break even with a $50,000 development cost, the app would need around 1,000 premium users in the first year, assuming a 10% conversion rate from free users.
- Gurpreet clarified that if CPI remains under $20, fewer than 100,000 users would be needed in a year to break even, which the group considered a realistic target.

Project scope and focus

- Participants agreed to focus the current project submission on phase one, with mentions of future phases included in the financials.

Business plan structure

- Participants discussed whether to integrate background research into the company description or allocate it to other sections of the business plan.
- Taylor agreed to keep the company description concise and place background research in other relevant sections of the business plan.

Project responsibilities

- Tom and Nick planned to collaborate on the operations plan, while Michelle will focus on the marketing plan, and Taylor will assist with domain access and logo selection.

Follow-up tasks

	Task	Assigned to	Due date	Bucket
1	Create the marketing plan and positioning strategy for the business plan (Nick, Gurpreet, Taylor)			
2	Finalize the financial and marketing plan, including pricing strategy and external references, for the business plan document (Nick, Gurpreet, Taylor)			
3	Draft the marketing plan and share with Tom for review by Sunday night (Michelle)			
4	Collaborate on the operations plan draft and prepare for group review (Nick, Tom)			

5	Upload the financial draft plan in Excel or Google Sheets for team review (Gurpreet)			
6	Schedule the next group meeting for the first week of April, skipping next week due to scheduling conflicts (Tom, Gurpreet, Nick, Michelle)			